

Maya A. Dalton

Pennsylvania State University

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[Website](#)

PRINCIPAL INTERESTS	Electoral violence, rebel groups & violent political organizations, gender politics, network analysis, and machine learning	
SKILLS	Technical: R programming language (proficient), L ^A T _E X(proficient), Python (proficient) Languages: English (native), Spanish (basic)	
EDUCATION	Pennsylvania State University	Expected 2026
	Ph.D. in Political Science and Social Data Analytics	
	<i>Major Field: Comparative Politics</i>	
	Pennsylvania State University	May 2024
	M.A. in Political Science	
	<i>Major Field: Comparative Politics</i> <i>Minor Field: Political Methodology</i>	
	Wake Forest University	May 2022
	B.A. in Politics and International Affairs	
	<i>Minors: Statistics and Communication</i>	
GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS	National Science Foundation	
	<i>Graduate Research Fellow - \$37,000 annual stipend and tuition waiver</i>	2023-2026
	Pennsylvania State University	
	<i>Graduate Research Award - \$4,569 summer stipend</i>	2023
	<i>Graduate Assistantship - \$26,700 annual stipend and tuition waiver</i>	2022-2023
	Wake Forest University	
	<i>Undergraduate Research Center - \$4,000 summer stipend</i>	2021
SCHOLARSHIP	PUBLICATIONS	
	Academic Articles	
	1. "Representation Behind Closed Doors: The Effect of Electing Women Mayors on Domestic Violence", with Giancarlo Visconti. 2026. <i>Journal of Politics</i> . [DOI]	
	2. "Measuring Changes in Corruption Over Time", with Justin Esarey. 2026. <i>Political Studies</i> . [DOI]	

Last Updated: 6/17/2026

Book Chapters

1. “The Changing Relationship between Gender and Corruption”, with Justin Esarey. 2024. *Handbook on Gender and Corruption in Democracies*, eds. Emily Bacchus Beaulieu and Tiffany D. Barnes. Cheltenham: Edward Elgar. [[PDF](#)].

Reports

1. “Homeownership and the American Dream During COVID”, with Ross Thomas. 2022. *The Nation*. [[LINK](#)]

WORK IN PROGRESS

Working Papers

1. “Memory Matters: Rethinking Structural Breaks in Conflict Time Series”, with Cecilia Cavero Sanchez.
2. “Predicting Civilian Electoral Contention”.
3. “Mapping the Hidden Structure of Electoral Violence”.
4. “For Better or For Worse? Gender Quotas and Electoral Violence”.

PROFESSIONAL NON-ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

EXPERIENCE United States Government

Graduate Intern - Analytical Methodologist May - August 2025

National Endowment for the Humanities

Pathways Intern - Office of Data and Evaluation May - December 2024

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Pennsylvania State University

Research Assistant - Dr. Daniel Tavana 2023

Research Assistant - Dr. Giancarlo Visconti 2023

Teaching Assistant - PLSC 3, Dr. Matt Golder 2022

Wake Forest University

Research Assistant - Dr. Justin Esarey 2021

Teaching Assistant - PLSC 280, Drs. Justin Esarey and Betina Wilkinson 2020-2022

University of Michigan - ICPSR Summer Program

Teaching Assistant - Dr. Robert Cooper 2023

CONFERENCES & SYMPOSIUMS

1. Electoral Integrity Project’s 6th Annual Virtual Elections Conference 2026
2. Junior Scholars in Quantitative Conflict (JQCon) Workshop 2026
3. Violence, Instability, and Peace (VIP) Workshop 2026
4. Peace Science Society International (PSSI) Rising Scholar Workshop 2025
5. Peace Science Society (PSSI) 2024-2025
6. American Political Science Association (APSA) 2023-2024
7. Midwest Workshop in Empirical Political Science (MWEPS XI) 2024

8. UNDOC Anti-Corruption Academic Symposium	2023
9. ICPSR Summer Program Blalock Lecture Series	2023
10. Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2022

HONORS & AWARDS

1. **Jack D. and Martha H. Fleeer Award**, Wake Forest University 2022
 - Awarded for meritorious performance in the political science major.
2. **Dorothy Shaw Leadership Award**, Alpha Delta Pi 2021
 - The highest individual honor given to a collegiate member of Alpha Delta Pi with a cumulative 3.40 GPA, is active in the chapter, and active in service on campus.
3. **Chinuntdet-Crowe Scholarship**, Wake Forest University 2021
 - Awarded to an upper-class student who has demonstrated “leadership skills by extensive involvement in, and leadership of, student organizations recognized by Wake Forest.”

MEMBERSHIPS **Graduate Association of Political Science (GAPS)**,
 Pennsylvania State University
Graduate Alliance for Diversity and Inclusion (GADI),
 Pennsylvania State University
American Political Science Association (APSA)
Peace Science Society (PSSI)
Pi Sigma Alpha, Alumni - Zeta Nu
Alpha Delta Pi Sorority (AΔΠ), Alumnae - Eta Upsilon

UNIVERSITY SERVICE	Pennsylvania State University	
	<i>Student Representative</i> , Graduate Studies Committee	2025-2026
	<i>President</i> , Graduate Association of Political Science (GAPS)	2024-2025
	<i>Vice President</i> , Graduate Association of Political Science (GAPS)	2023-2024
	Wake Forest University	
	<i>Vice President of Member Development</i> , Alpha Delta Pi - Eta Upsilon	2021-2022
	<i>President's Aide</i> , Office of the President	2021-2022
	<i>Student Advisor</i> , Office of Academic Advising	2020-2022

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE **Discussant:** *American Political Science Association (APSA)*
Reviewer: *Journal of Politics, Comparative Political Studies, Politics and Gender, PS: Political Science & Politics*

REFERENCES

1. **Dr. James Piazza**
410 SWLAB, University Park, PA 16802
jap45@psu.edu
2. **Dr. Bruce Desmarais**
419 SWLAB, University Park, PA 16802
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